Holmes Tuttle's group hired a California political consulting company headed by Stuart Spencer and William Roberts to look over my speaking invitations and pick out ones they thought would get me around the state, but exclude Republican functions; the idea was to avoid partisan events and speak to ordinary Californians.

Starting roughly July 1, 1965, I drove up and down the length and breadth of California for six months, commuting to luncheon and dinner meetings from San Diego at the southern border all the way to the coastal fishing villages near the Oregon border.

I'd give a speech, then get in my car and drive to the next one, meeting the members of organizations like the Rotary Club, Chamber of Commerce, and United Way.

The speeches had pretty much the same flavor that my speeches had had since the later years on the General Electric plant tours; after the speeches, I'd hear a lot of the same things from members of the audience that I'd heard for years on the GE tours: People were tired of wasteful government programs and welfare chiselers; and they were angry about the constant spiral of taxes and government regulations, arrogant bureaucrats, and public officials who thought all of mankind's problems could be solved by throwing the taxpayers' dollars at them.

Their comments didn't surprise me. By then, I'd come to expect it when I went out to the grass roots of America. But I *was* surprised by something else: No matter where I went, in San Jose or Modesto, Los Angeles or Newport Beach, after I'd give a speech, people would be waiting and they'd come up to me and say, "Why don't you run for governor?"

I'd laugh and give my standard response: "I'm an actor, not a politician," then ask them to suggest someone who was really qualified to be governor. But all I heard were voices of more people chiming in to urge me to run against Brown.